

SPARTAN COACHING

HOSPICE SALES EXCELLENCE

Physician Relationship Building & CME Strategy

WHY PHYSICIANS HESITATE ON HOSPICE

- **Fear of "Giving Up":**
Physicians trained to fight disease. Hospice feels like failure.
- **Liability Concerns:**
Worried about legal implications of certification
- **Time Burden:**
Certification paperwork + family conversations = hours of work
- **Referral Relationships:**
May have existing hospice relationship they're loyal to
- **Clinical Knowledge Gaps:**
Don't know the specific eligibility criteria

THE ENGAGEMENT FRAMEWORK (Don't Go Straight to Sales)

1. **EDUCATE:** Provide CME-eligible hospice training (shows you respect their expertise)
2. **CREDIBILITY:** Share clinical guidelines and protocols (not a sales pitch)
3. **SUPPORT:** Offer to streamline their certification process (make their job easier)
4. **PARTNERSHIP:** Position as collaborators in best patient outcomes (not competitors)
5. **REFERRAL:** Ask for feedback and refinement (show you value their input)

PHYSICIAN-SPECIFIC OBJECTIONS & RESPONSES

""We refer to [competitor]. We've got it handled.""

"I totally respect that. We're actually complementary—many physicians we work with manage multiple referral partners. What we do is streamline the certification and documentation process so it's less burden on you. Could we show you how that works?"

""I don't have time for more referral conversations.""

"That's exactly why we exist. We handle the initial patient identification, family education, and paperwork so that when it comes to you, it's just a clinical certification. Two-page form, not a 30-minute conversation."

""Patients always refuse hospice anyway.""

"That's a teaching moment. When families understand hospice is about comfort + family time (not giving up), acceptance goes up significantly. We train your staff on the conversation. Has your team had that training?"

CME/LUNCH & LEARN TALKING POINTS

"We'd love to support your physicians with a quick CME-eligible session on hospice eligibility criteria and certification best practices. 30 minutes, lunch provided, and physicians get CME credit. Interested in scheduling something next quarter?"